The official magazine of Scouting America

Scout Life

Subscribe! *get the magazine*

Trailhead

START YOUR ADVENTURE → 0.1 mi

what's hot!

How to Make a Ghost Decoration Using a Cardboard Tube

Turn an empty cardboard tube into a friendly floating ghost. It's a quick Halloween craft you can make this afternoon.

easy craft! ~30 min

Features

Let's Talk to the Author of 'Diary of a Wimpy Kid'

Animals & Nature

Creepy But Cool: These 5 Critters Are More Helpful Than Scary

Scouting Around

Use the Compass Game to Improve Your Navigation Skills

Games

Bike Blitz

QUICK FUN → 0.2 mi

laugh, learn, do! ↓

Joke of the Day *ha ha ha!*

★ TODAY'S JOKE

WILLIAM: What keys unlock a banana?
EMMA: What?
WILLIAM: Monkeys.

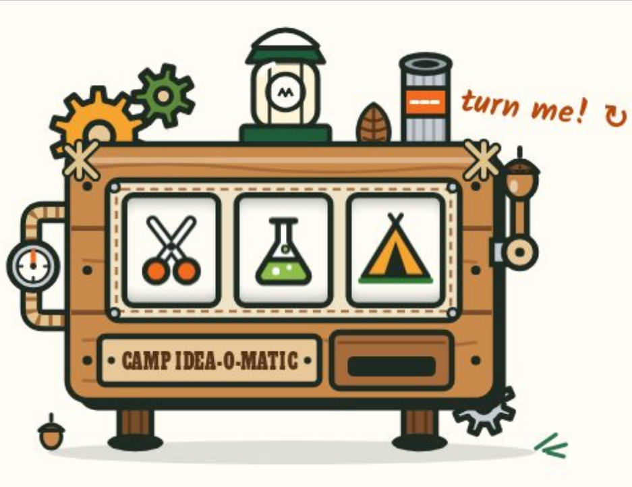
Joke by William R., Katy, Texas

Animals | Food | Knock-Knock
Scouting | Monsters | Space

Laugh-o-Meter

More jokes → | Send us your joke →

Idea Machine *bored?*



Crank it! *...or turn the crank yourself! ↗*

More projects → | Fun stuff to do →

Requirements Finder *get advancement help*

① I'm in... ☐ Cub Scouts ☐ Scouts BSA
② Rank: Choose a rank... ▾
③ Adventure or requirement: Pick a rank first ▾

↖ Pick your program, rank and requirement. We'll pin helpful Scout Life resources right here!

Popular: Memorize the Scout Law | Compass Game | 7 Basic Scout Knots | Magic Tricks

More Scouting stuff →

Poll *vote!*

What's the best campfire snack?

- S'mores
- Hot dogs on a stick
- Banana boats
- Campfire popcorn

Tap your pick! One vote per Scout.

More polls → *yum!*

Lake ahead!

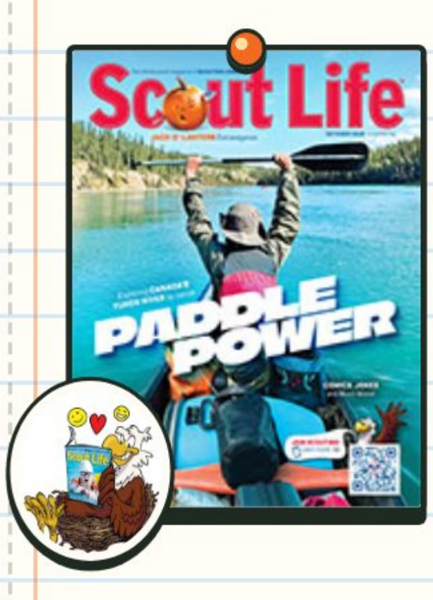
Video of the Week

Tales From the Campfire

Pull up a log! The Scout Life crew shares a not-too-spooky story made for telling around the fire.

More videos on our YouTube channel →

SUBSCRIBE TODAY!



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Halfway there

PLAY & EXPLORE → 0.5 mi

games, gear & spooky stuff

Halloween HQ *spooky-ooky!*

Pumpkin Carver | Trick-or-Treat Door

17 days until Halloween!

Eyes ▲ ● ★ ⌒
Nose ▲ ● ◆ ••
Mouth

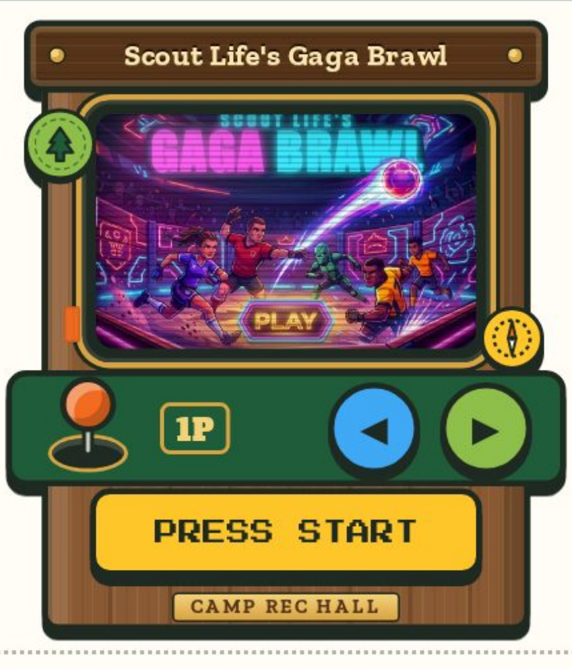
Pick eyes, a nose and a mouth to light the candle.

Spooky picks

- How to Make a Ghost Decoration Using a...
- How to Make Faux Stained-Glass Art for...
- 101 Funny Halloween Jokes and Comics
- Creepy But Cool: These 5 Critters Are More...

More Halloween fun →

Arcade *free games!*



now on screen:

Scout Life's Gaga Brawl

Will you be the last brawler standing? Dodge the red-hot ball in this online gaga ball video game.

field note: that joystick really wiggles ↺

See all games → *1 of 6*

See all games → *works on phones & tablets!*

Gear Guide *pack smart!*

Ask the Gear Guy

Recommended Gear for a Philmont Backpacking Trek

Q: I'm going backpacking at Philmont Scout Ranch and need some new gear. What do you...

Buying Guide

How to Buy a Backpacking Stove For Your Next Camping Adventure

Bring your appetite — these backpacking stoves can make a camp chef out of anyone.

swipe →

All gear guides → | Ask the Gear Guy →

Quiz *think fast!*

Q2 OF 10

Which two sports make up a duathlon?

Ⓐ Running and swimming
Ⓑ Running and cycling
Ⓒ Swimming and rowing
Ⓓ Checkers and pickleball

What's the answer?

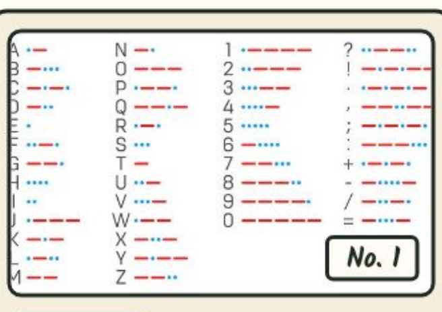
9 more brain-busters in the full quiz.

Take the full quiz → | More quizzes →

FIND SOMETHING AWESOME → 0.8 mi

more to discover

Fun Stuff to Do *try it!*



Fun Stuff

Learn Morse Code With This Morse Translator and Decoder

Fun Stuff

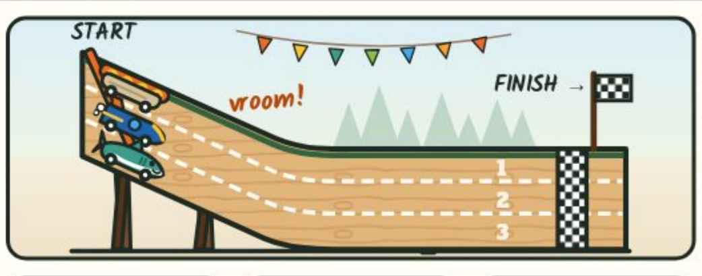
How to Fold Your Own Pocket-Sized Joke Books

Magic

Learn the 'Torn and Restored Dollar Bill' Magic Trick

More Fun Stuff →

Pinewood Derby



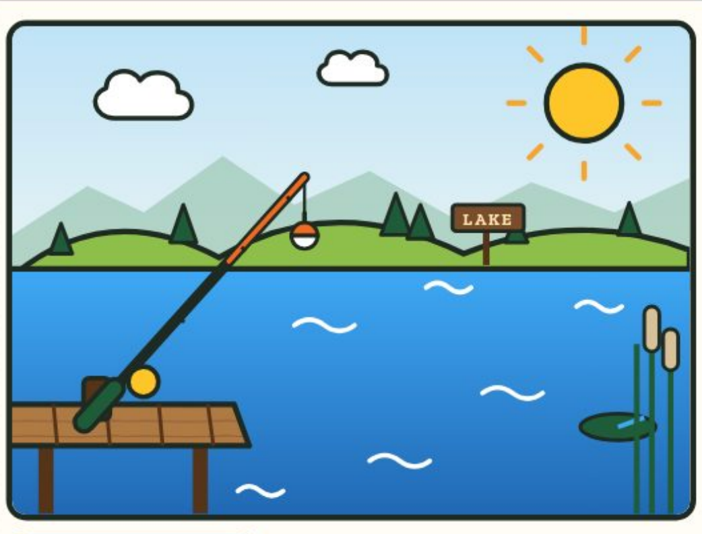
Hot Dog | Rocket | Shark Fin

Race! *Pick your car, then hit Race!*

Fast-car tips | 2026 Hall of Fame

Pinewood Derby HQ →

Fishing *bite?*



Cast! *Tap Cast! and see what you reel in.*

More fishing → *lake log: ~ ><(((°> ~*

Scout Essentials *go outside!*

Scouting Around

Scouts Go the Extra Mile With the Multisport Merit Badge

Outdoors & Gear

Create an Emergency Pack or Kit

More Scouting Around → | More Outdoors & Gear →

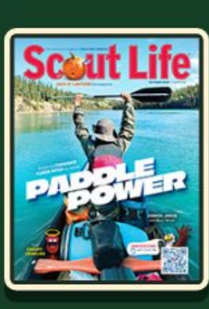
Camp

Psst... there are secrets hidden on this page.

Hold to toast

Toast a marshmallow!

Scout Life Magazine



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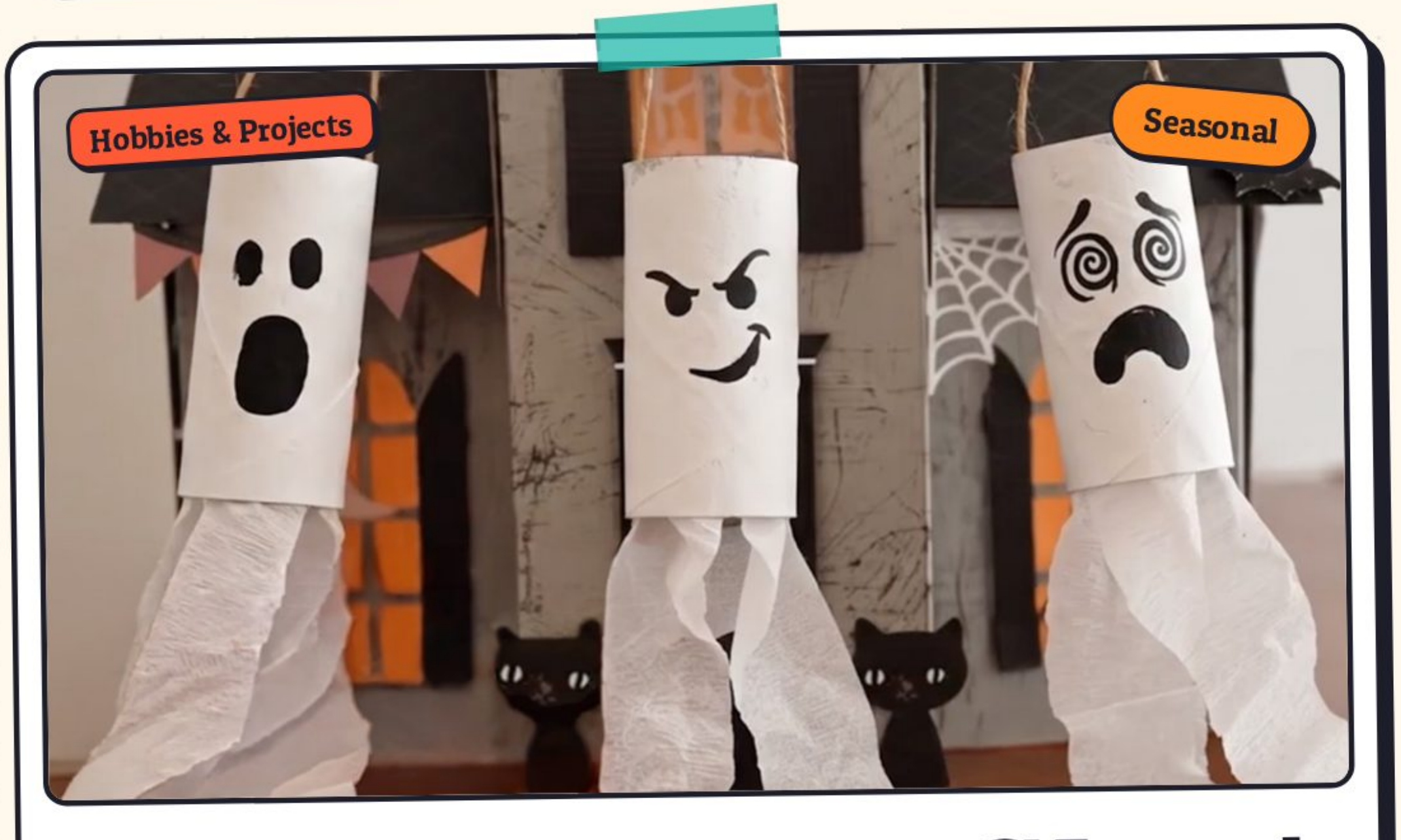
Make friends and go on big adventures near you!

Find a Pack or Troop →

Today's Top Picks

fresh this week! ✎


Hobbies & Projects
Seasonal

How to Make a Ghost Decoration Using a Cardboard Tube

Turn an empty cardboard tube into a friendly floating ghost. It's a quick Halloween craft you can make this afternoon.

Read it →

New
Features
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Read →

Animals & Nature
Creepy But Cool: These 5 Critters Are More Helpful Than Scary
Read →

Scouting Around
Use the Compass Game to Improve Your Navigation Skills
Read →

Games
Bike Blitz
Play ▶

Quick Fun

laugh, think, decide! ↓

Joke of the Day

ha!

★ Today's pick

WILLIAM: What keys unlock a banana?
EMMA: What?
WILLIAM: Monkeys.

Joke by William R., Katy, Texas

Find a joke:
Animals · Food · Knock-Knock · Scouting · Monsters · Space

Laugh-o-Meter

More jokes →
Send us your joke ✎

Idea Machine

bored?

Crank it!
...or turn the crank yourself! ↗

More projects →
Fun stuff to do →

Requirements Finder

① I'm in...
Cub Scouts · Scouts BSA

② Rank
Choose a rank...

③ Adventure or requirement
Pick a rank first

↖ Pick your program, rank and requirement. We'll pin matching Scout Life stories right here!

Popular: Memorize the Scout Law · Compass Game · 7 Basic Scout Knots · Fast Pinewood Derby Car

More Scouting stuff →
for scouts, parents & leaders ✓

Today's Poll

vote!

What's the best campfire snack?

- S'mores
- Hot dogs on a stick
- Banana boats
- Campfire popcorn

Tap your pick! One vote per Scout.

More polls →
yum! ✶

Video of the Week

Tales From the Campfire

Pull up a log! The Scout Life crew shares a not-too-spooky story made for telling around the fire.

More videos on our YouTube channel →

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Play & Explore

games, gear & spooky stuff

Halloween HQ

spooky-ooky!

Pumpkin Carver · Trick-or-Treat Door

17 days until Halloween!

Carve it for real →

Pick eyes, a nose and a mouth to light the candle.

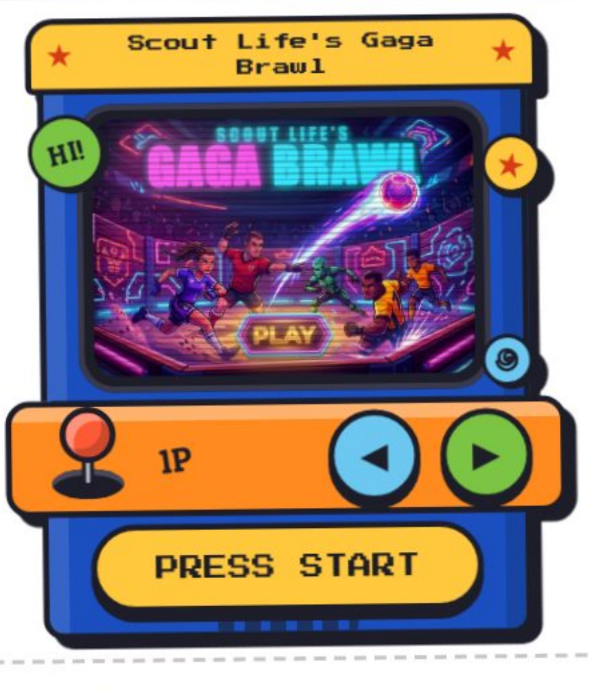
Spooky picks 👀

- How to Make a Ghost Decoration Using a...
- How to Make Faux Stained-Glass Art for...
- 101 Funny Halloween Jokes and Comics
- Creepy But Cool: These 5 Critters Are More...

More Halloween fun →
boo! ✎

Arcade

free games!



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psst... that joystick really wiggles ↺

See all games →
1 of 6

See all games →
works on phones & tablets!

Gear Guide

pack smart!

Ask the Gear Guy
Recommended Gear for a Philmont Backpacking Trek
Q: I'm going backpacking at Philmont Scout Ranch and need some new gear. What do you...

Buying Guide
How to Buy a Backpacking Stove For Your Next Camping Adventure
Bring your appetite — these backpacking stoves can make a camp chef out of anyone.

← swipe →

All gear guides →
Ask the Gear Guy →

Quiz Teaser

think fast!

Q2 of 10

MULTISPORT MERIT BADGE QUIZ

Which two sports make up a duathlon?

Ⓐ Running and swimming
Ⓑ Running and cycling
Ⓒ Swimming and rowing
Ⓓ Checkers and pickleball

Tap an answer sticker! ☝

9 more brain-busters in the full quiz.

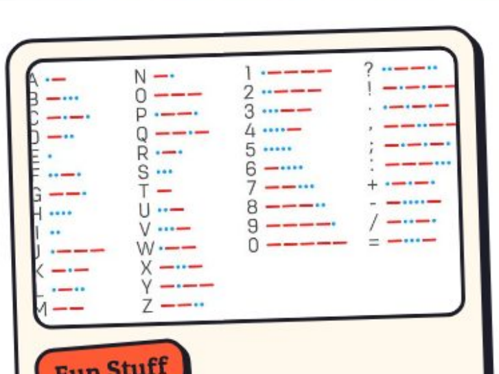
Take the full quiz →
More quizzes →

Read Something Awesome

fresh from every section

Fun Stuff to Do

try it!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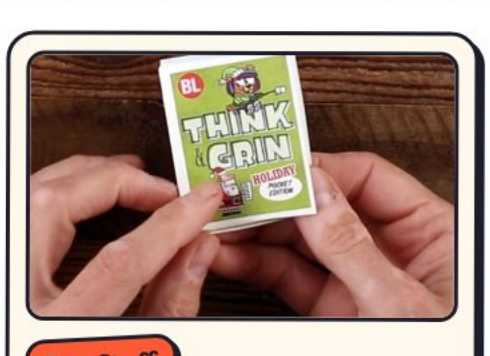
Learn Morse Code With This Morse Translator and Decoder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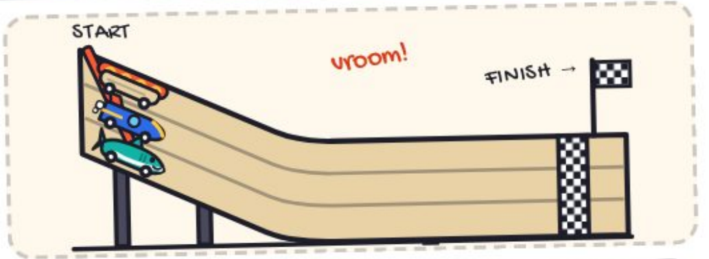
How to Fold Your Own Pocket-Sized Joke Books

Magic
Learn the 'Torn and Restored Dollar Bill' Magic Trick

More Fun Stuff →

Pinewood Derby



Hot Dog · Rocket · Shark Fin

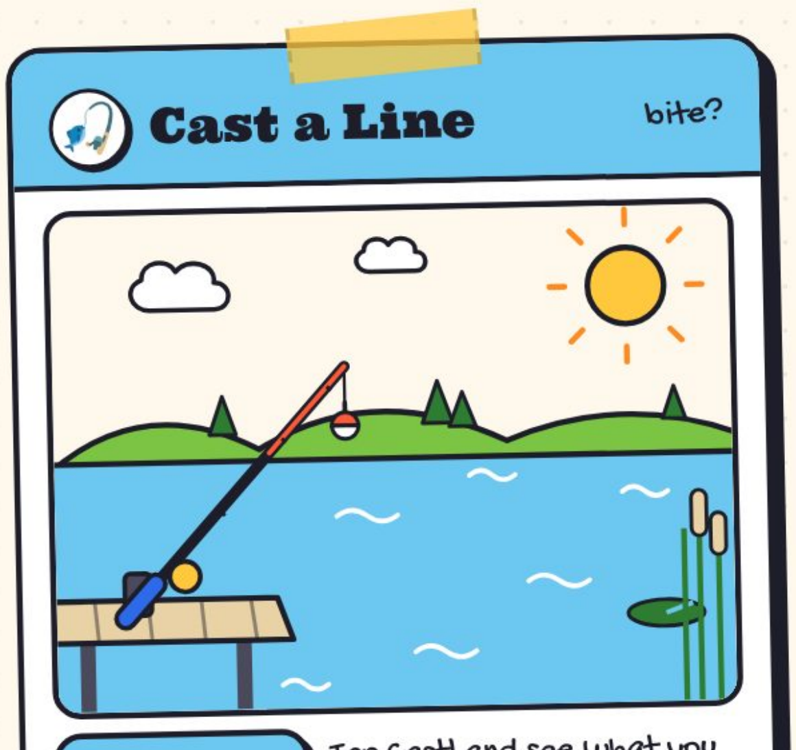
Race!
Pick your car, then hit Race!

Fast-car tips
2026 Hall of Fame

Pinewood Derby HQ →

Cast a Line

bite?



Cast!
Tap Cast! and see what you reel in.

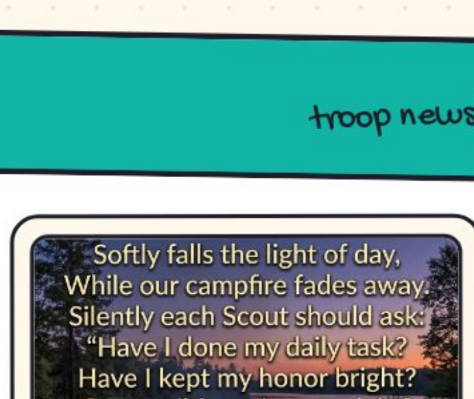
More fishing →

Scouting Around

troop news!

Merit Badges
Scouts Go the Extra Mile With the Multisport Merit Badge

Troop Tips
Four Creative Fundraising Ideas for Scout Troops


Softly falls the light of day,
While our campfire fades away.
Silently each Scout should ask:
"Have I done my daily task?
Have I kept my honor bright?
Can I guiltless sleep tonight?
Have I done and have I dared
Everything to be prepared?"

Traditions
How to Sing Scout Vespers With Lyrics and Music

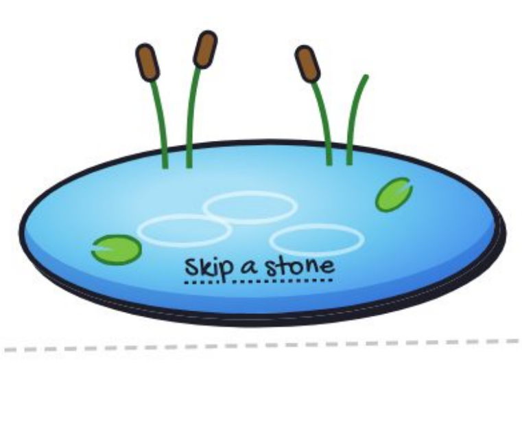
More Scouting Around →

Outdoors & Gear

go outside!

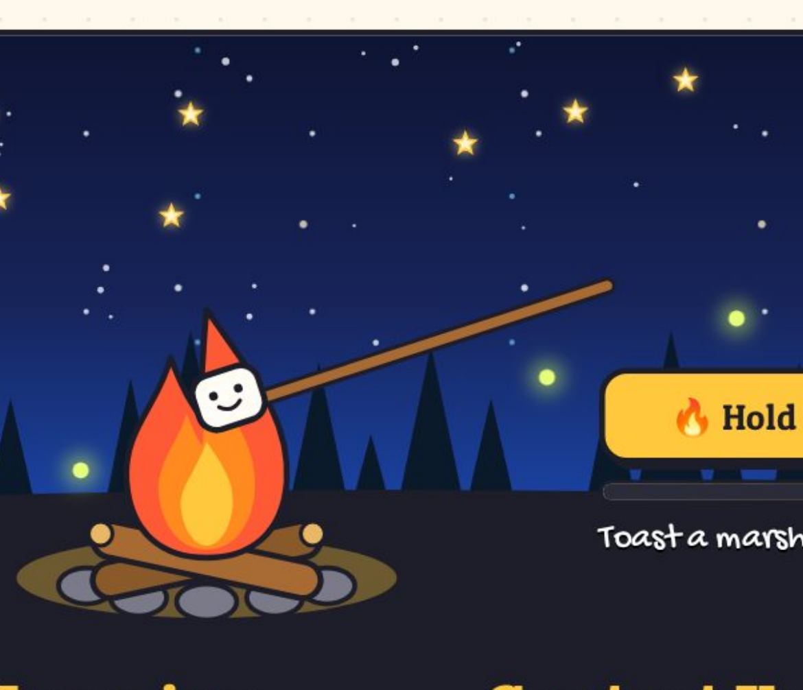
Ask the Gear Guy
How Do I Prevent Blisters?

Be Prepared
Create an Emergency Pack or Kit


Skip a stone

More Outdoors & Gear →

Psst... there are secrets hidden on this page.



🔥 Hold to toast
Toast a marshmallow!

Explore
Games · Jokes · Outdoors & Gear · Hobbies & Projects · Scouts · Contests & Giveaways

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START Featured Levels ▶ SELECT A LEVEL

How to Make a Ghost Decoration Using a Cardboard Tube

Turn an empty cardboard tube into a friendly floating ghost. It's a quick Halloween craft you can make this afternoon.

▶ Read it

FEATURES
Let's Talk to the Author of 'Diary of a Wimpy Kid'
▶ Read

ANIMALS & NATURE
Creepy But Cool: These 5 Critters Are More Helpful Than Scary
▶ Read

SCOUTING AROUND
Use the Compass Game to Improve Your Navigation Skills
▶ Read

GAMES
Bike Blitz
▶ Play

WORLD 1 Quick Fun LAUGH · THINK · DECIDE

Joke of the Day HA!

★ TODAY'S PICK
WILLIAM: What keys unlock a banana?
EMMA: What?
WILLIAM: Monkeys.
Joke by William R., Katy, Texas

▶ PICK A TOPIC
Animals | Food | Knock-Knock
Scouting | Monsters | Space

LAUGH-O-METER

More jokes ▶ Send us your joke

Idea Machine BORED?

Crank it! OR TURN THE CRANK ↗

More projects ▶ Fun stuff to do ▶

Requirements Finder QUEST 0/3

1 Choose your player: Cub Scouts | Scouts BSA
2 Rank: Choose a rank... ▾
3 Adventure or requirement: Pick a rank first ▾

▲ QUEST LOG
Pick your program, rank and requirement to unlock matching Scout Life stories!
POPULAR: Memorize the Scout Law | Compass Game | 7 Basic Scout Knots | Fast Pinewood Derby Car

More Scouting stuff ▶ SCOUTS · PARENTS · LEADERS

Today's Poll VOTE!

What's the best campfire snack?
S'mores | Hot dogs on a stick
VS
Banana boats | Campfire popcorn
▶ CHOOSE YOUR TEAM!
One vote per Scout.

More polls ▶ YUM!

★ BONUS STAGE ★

Video of the Week ON AIR

Tales From the Campfire
Pull up a log! The Scout Life crew shares a not-too-spooky story made for telling around the fire.

More videos on our YouTube channel ▶

★ POWER-UP ★

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UNLOCK:
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WORLD 2 Play & Explore GAMES · GEAR · SPOOKY STUFF

Haunted Level WORLD 10-31

Pumpkin Carver | Trick-or-Treat Door

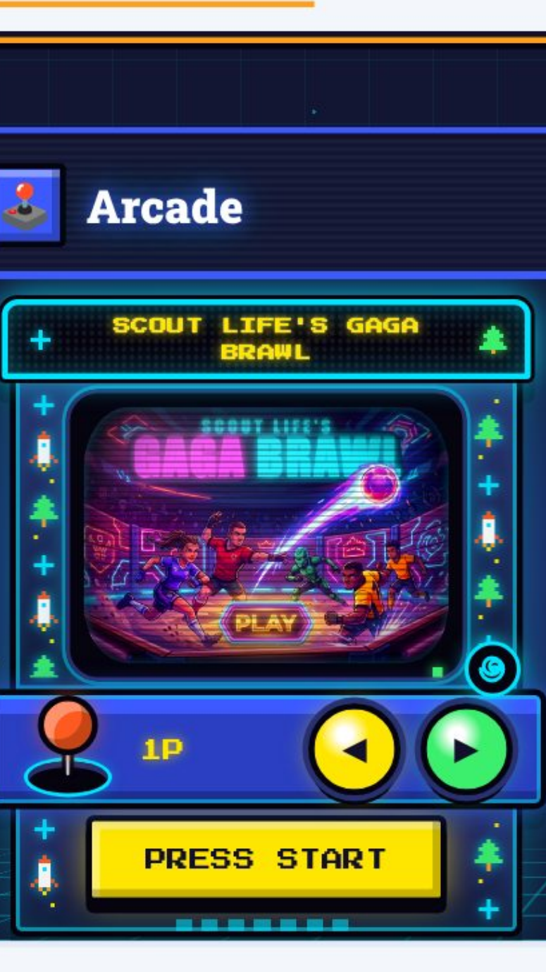
CREATE-A-PUMPKIN
EYES ▲ ● ★ ⌒
NOSE ▲ ● ◆ ●●
MOUTH
Carve it for real ▶
Pick eyes, a nose and a mouth to light the candle.

HALLOWEEN TIMER
17 DAYS LEFT

▶ SPOOKY PICKS
- How to Make a Ghost Decoration...
- How to Make Faux Stained-Glass Art...
- 101 Funny Halloween Jokes...
- Creepy But Cool: These 5 Critters A...

More Halloween fun ▶ BOO!

Arcade FREE GAMES!

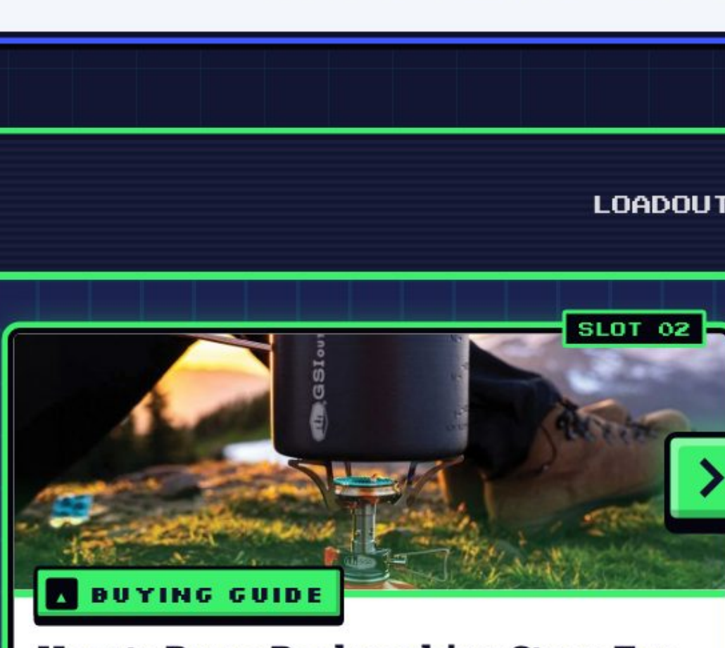


▶ NOW PLAYING
Scout Life's Gaga Brawl
Will you be the last brawler standing? Dodge the red-hot ball in this online gaga ball video game.
PSST... SPIN THE STICK ↻
See all games ▶ GAME 1 OF 6

See all games ▶ PLAYS ON PHONES + TABLETS

Gear Guide LOADOUT

ASK THE GEAR GUY
Recommended Gear for a Philmont Backpacking Trek
Q: I'm going backpacking at Philmont Scout Ranch and need some new gear. What do you...



BUYING GUIDE
How to Buy a Backpacking Stove For Your Next Camping Adventure
Bring your appetite — these backpacking stoves can make a camp chef out of anyone.

◀ SWIPE ▶

All gear guides ▶ Ask the Gear Guy ▶

Quiz Teaser THINK FAST!

ROUND 2 OF 10

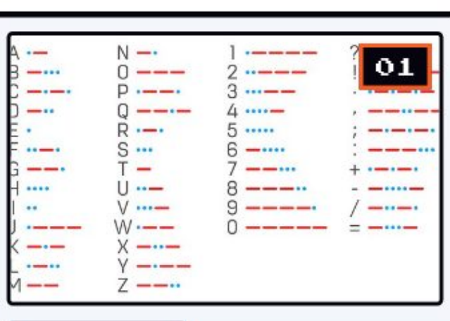
MULTISPORT MERIT BADGE QUIZ
Which two sports make up a duathlon?
A Running and swimming
B Running and cycling
C Swimming and rowing
D Checkers and pickleball

▶ PICK A, B, C OR D
9 more brain-busters in the full quiz.

Take the full quiz ▶ More quizzes ▶

WORLD 3 Read Something Awesome FRESH FROM EVERY SECTION

Fun Stuff to Do TRY IT!



FUN STUFF
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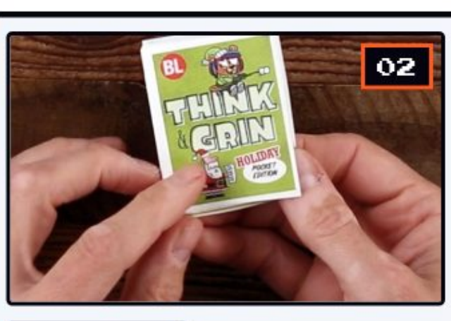
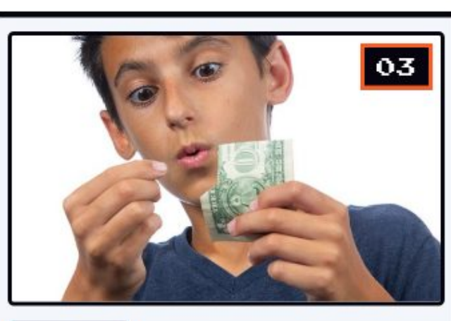


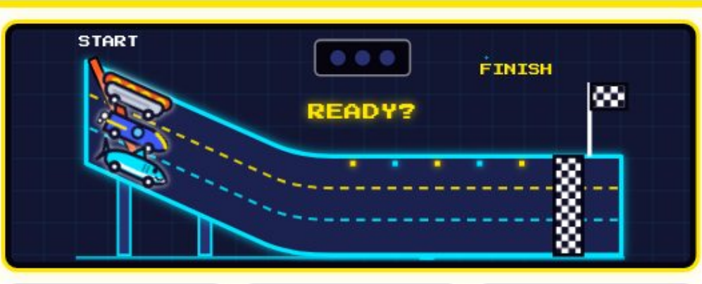
FUN STUFF
How to Fold Your Own Pocket-Sized Joke Books



MAGIC
Learn the 'Torn and Restored Dollar Bill' Magic Trick

More Fun Stuff ▶

Pinewood Derby



Hot Dog | Rocket | Shark Fin
Race! Pick your car, then hit Race!
Fast-car tips | 2026 Hall of Fame

Pinewood Derby HQ ▶

Cast a Line BITE?

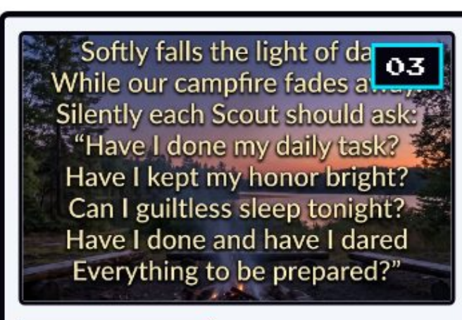
CAST! Tap Cast! and see what you reel in.

More fishing ▶ TIGHT LINES!

Scouting Around TROOP NEWS!

MERIT BADGES
Scouts Go the Extra Mile With the Multisport Merit Badge

TROOP TIPS
Four Creative Fundraising Ideas for Scout Troops


03
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TRADITIONS
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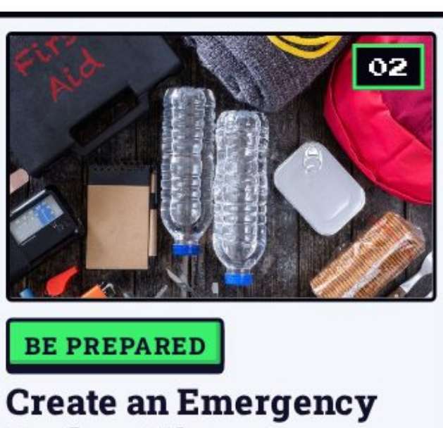
More Scouting Around ▶

Outdoors & Gear GO OUTSIDE!

ASK THE GEAR GUY
How Do I Prevent Blisters?

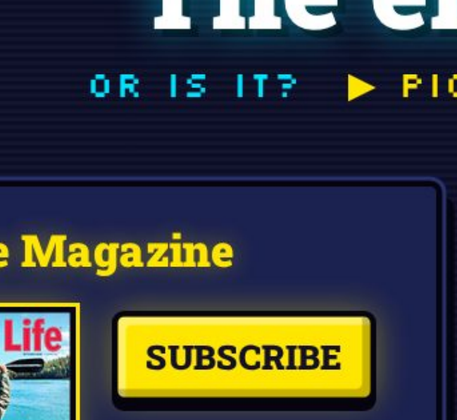


BE PREPARED
Create an Emergency Pack or Kit

More Outdoors & Gear ▶

Psst... there are secrets hidden on this page.

BONUS: CAMPFIRE STAGE



Hold to toast
Toast a marshmallow!

The end...

OR IS IT? ▶ PICK A MENU

▶ Menu
Games | Jokes | Outdoors & Gear | Hobbies & Projects | Scouts | Contests & Giveaways

▶ The Magazine

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